

## SPAN580C COLINA

### RICHNESS OF THE BASE

**Definition:** No restrictions can be placed on the input (underlying representation)

#### **Phonological Contrast**

Contrast in derivational models: UR

Contrast in OT: constraints and constraint ranking

Contrast in OT is determined by interaction of faithfulness and markedness

Faith > markedness = contrast

Markedness > Faith = no contrast

#### Lexicon Optimization (principle of language acquisition)

All else being equal, the learner selects the input that is closest to the output. The input that is more dissimilar to the input will incur more violations of faithfulness, so the learner selects the one that is more similar to the input.

1. Output: [ma]

Ranking: IDENT nasal >> \*nasal

what is the UR /pa/ /ma/?

(i)

/pa/ Ident nasal >> \*nasal  
[ma] \* \*

(ii)

/ma/ Ident nasal >> \*nasal  
[ma] \*

answer: (ii), /ma/ is the best output for [ma]

2. How does a child know that IDENT nasal >> \*nasal? Because he/she hears oye [pa] and [ma]

Otherwise the output would invariably be [pa], with neutralization of contrast. For the output [pa] the best input is /pa/ ("most harmonious input).

Question: What would be the result of \*nasal >> IDENT nasal ?

#### **Ejercicios:**

¿Cómo explicarías la falta de contraste entre vocales nasales y orales en español? Es decir, ¿cómo se explica el hecho de que [tẽn] y [ten] correspondan al mismo input /ten/? ¿Y cómo se explica que en francés *beau* [bo] "bonito" y *bon* [bõ] "bueno" correspondan a dos aductos diferentes /bo/ y /bõ/

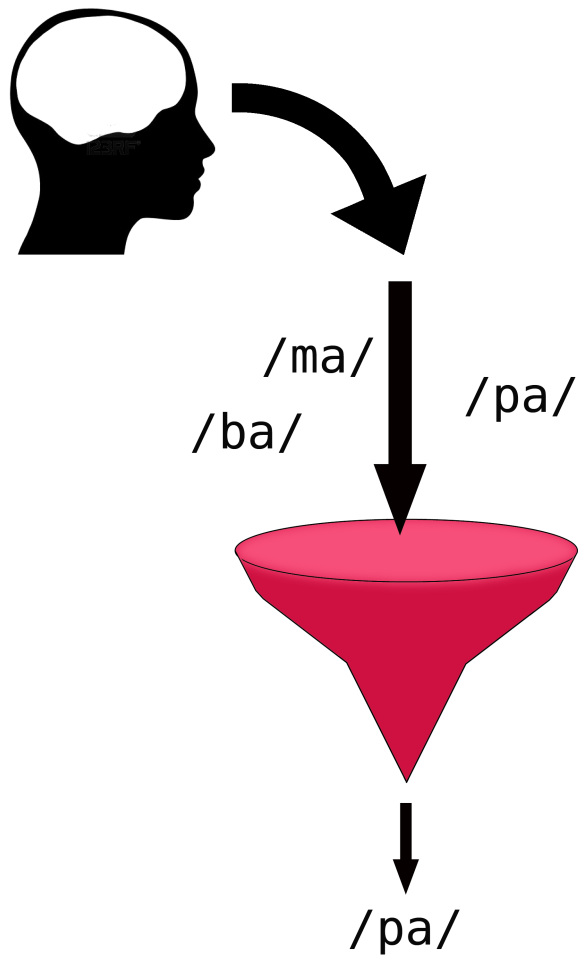


Table 1: In Spanish, Markedness dominates Faith for nasal vowels

|    | /ten/ | *NASAL | IDENT NASAL |
|----|-------|--------|-------------|
| a. | /ten/ |        | *           |
| b. | /tên/ | *!     | *           |

Table 2: In French, Faith dominates Markedness for nasal vowels

|    | /bõ/ | IDENT NASAL | *NASAL |
|----|------|-------------|--------|
| a. | /bõ/ |             | *      |
| b. | /bo/ | *!          |        |

Table 3: In French, Faith dominates Markedness for nasal vowels

|    | /bo/ | IDENT NASAL | *NASAL |
|----|------|-------------|--------|
| a. | /bo/ |             | *      |
| b. | /bõ/ | *!          |        |

## Questions

- If this is indeed correct, why would French have a \*NASAL constraint?
- Could it be a NASAL constraint instead?